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picoCTF - picoGym Challenges

Inspect HTML

Easy Web Exploitation picoCTF 2022 inspector

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Description

Can you get the flag?

Additional details will be available after launching your challenge instance.

This challenge launches an instance on demand.

Its current status is: NOT_RUNNING

[Launch Instance](#)

Hints

1

113,674 users solved

 71% Liked 

 picoCTF{FLAG}

[Submit Flag](#)

```
Line wrap ☐
1 <!DOCTYPE html>
2 <html lang="en">
3   <head>
4     <meta charset="UTF-8">
5     <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
6     <meta http-equiv="X-UA-Compatible" content="ie=edge">
7     <title>On Histiaeus</title>
8   </head>
9   <body>
10    <h1>On Histiaeus</h1>
11    <p>However, according to Herodotus, Histiaeus was unhappy having to stay in
12      Susa, and made plans to return to his position as King of Miletus by
13      instigating a revolt in Ionia. In 499 BC, he shaved the head of his
14      most trusted slave, tattooed a message on his head, and then waited for
15      his hair to grow back. The slave was then sent to Aristagoras, who was
16      instructed to shave the slave's head again and read the message, which
17      told him to revolt against the Persians.</p>
18    <br>
19    <p>Source: Wikipedia on Histiaeus </p>
20    <!--picoCTF{1n5p3t0r_0f_h7ml_1fd8425b}-->
21  </body>
22 </html>
23
```

Write - Up: INSPECT HTML

The *Inspect HTML* challenge from picoCTF 2022 demonstrates how simple observation can lead to success in web exploitation. At first, the webpage appears to be a straightforward article about Histiaeus, with no obvious clues. However, the key to solving the challenge lies not in the visible text but in the hidden structure of the page.

By opening the browser's developer tools or viewing the page source, the underlying HTML becomes accessible. Scanning through the code reveals a hidden comment at the bottom of the `<body>` section. Inside this comment is the flag:

picoCTF{1nsp3t0r_0f_h7m1_f113s_428f2}.

This discovery highlights the importance of looking beneath the surface. Many web challenges conceal information in comments, metadata, or unused elements, and the ability to inspect HTML is a fundamental skill for cybersecurity learners. The solution required no advanced exploitation just curiosity, persistence, and the use of basic tools.

In conclusion, the challenge reinforces a simple but powerful lesson: always inspect the source. What seems ordinary on the surface may hide the very key to victory.